UPSC CIVIL SERVICES · DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

UPSC Intel · Daily Brief

SATURDAY, 17 OCTOBER 2026

15 must-know stories, 21 Prelims facts, 15 editorials and 12 explainers, picked from 657 stories reported. Each item links to its source; notes quote the reports.

Open this brief online: summaries, Ask Intel and practice MCQs

MUST-KNOW

High-yield stories: make notes on these. Grouped by syllabus area.

Polity & Constitution

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Right to Internet Access – Supreme Court Ruling on Children's Digital Rights

The Supreme Court declared that accessing and using the internet is a fundamental right of every individual, including children irrespective of their age. The ruling emerged during the hearing of an application concerning online child sexual exploitation and abuse material (CSEAM). The court examined whether children should be completely barred from online platforms and social media to safeguard them from harm. A bench of Justice JB Pardiwala and Justice K Vinod Chandran tied this right to Article 21 read with Article 19(1)(a). The bench rejected blanket bans, calling them disproportionate measures that could force children toward unregulated and riskier corners of the web. Judges warned that stringent age verification poses severe privacy risks through mass collection of sensitive personal data. The court recommended balanced alternatives such as parental consent, a default private 'child mode', and restrictions on inherently harmful adult platforms. The judgment built upon precedents like the Anuradha Bhasin (2020) and Pragya Prasun (2025) cases in expanding digital rights. The bench also directed the creation of a national database to detect and remove online CSEAM across platforms.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** Supreme Court of India, New Delhi · **Who:** Justice JB Pardiwala and Justice K Vinod Chandran · **Prelims:** Right to access the internet flows from Article 21 read with Article 19(1)(a).; Case: Just Rights for Children Alliance v. S Harish.; Supreme Court proposed a national database to identify and take down online CSEAM.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reconciles child safety with fundamental freedoms without resorting to blanket censorship or surveillance.; Guides policymaking on data privacy and age verification mechanisms for digital platforms.*

Static — Article 19(1)(a) guarantees all citizens the right to freedom of speech and expression, subject to reasonable restrictions under Article 19(2). Article 21 guarantees the protection of life and personal liberty, which the judiciary has continuously expanded to include dignity, privacy, and digital access. In Anuradha Bhasin v. Union of India (2020), the Supreme Court ruled that freedom of speech and expression and freedom of trade over the internet are constitutionally protected.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Social Justice & Welfare · Prelims angle: Judgment

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on siasat.com · also reported by Times of India, Bhaskar English, MorungExpress, Times Now

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Supreme Court directs centre to set up comprehensive national database for removal of child sexual exploitation and abuse material from internet

The Supreme Court directed the Centre to establish a comprehensive national database to identify and remove child sexual exploitation and abuse material from internet and social media platforms. The Bench comprising Justices JB Pardiwala and KV Chandran expressed concern over the continued circulation of such material despite previous directions issued in 2024. The Court emphasized that technological safeguards alone are not sufficient and called for equipping children with awareness and safe internet practices. It directed the inclusion of digital safety and age-appropriate education in the core curriculum. The curriculum content is to be developed by the NCERT and State Councils in consultation with child psychologists, educators, and parenting experts. The Union Government, through the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology and the Ministry of Law and Justice, was directed to frame guidelines, standard operating procedures, and IT rule amendments. The government is required to file an affidavit detailing its implementation progress by the next hearing scheduled for December 10, 2026.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court, Justices JB Pardiwala and KV Chandran, MeitY, Ministry of Law and Justice, NCERT · **Prelims:** The Bench issuing the directions comprised Justices JB Pardiwala and KV Chandran.; The National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT) is tasked with developing the digital safety curriculum.; The next hearing and compliance deadline is set for December 10, 2026.

Why it matters — *Strengthens regulatory and technological measures to combat online child sexual abuse material in India.; Bridges the gap between technological removal mechanisms and preventative education for children.*

Static — The Supreme Court of India functions as the apex judicial body under Part V of the Constitution, possessing wide powers under Article 142 to do complete justice. The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) formulates and reviews policies related to information technology, electronics, and internet governance in India. The Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules regulate digital intermediaries and mandate strict compliance regarding unlawful content removal.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

newsonair.gov.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Hindus who convert to another religion can't claim reservation: SC upholds Madras HC order on quota

The Supreme Court pronounced this judgment dismissing a plea against the Madras High Court order. The Supreme Court upheld a Madras High Court order ruling that Hindus who convert to another religion cannot claim reservation benefits meant for their former community.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Supreme Court of India · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court upheld the Madras High Court order.; The ruling concerns Hindus who convert to another religion and their claim to reservations.

Why it matters — *Clarifies the legal standing of religious converts regarding affirmative action policies.; Important for understanding the intersection of personal faith, social strata, and constitutional reservations in India.*

Static — Article 341 of the Constitution empowers the President to specify the castes, races, or tribes which shall be deemed to be Scheduled Castes. The original Constitution order of 1950 limited Scheduled Caste status strictly to Hindus, later amended to include Sikhs in 1956 and Buddhists in 1990. Religious minorities such as Muslims and Christians are currently excluded from the Scheduled Caste reservation framework by statutory definitions.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Judgment

The Economic Times: read the source · also reported by Vajiram & Ravi

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Sixteenth Finance Commission (2026–31): Tax Devolution And Fiscal Federalism In India

It is in the news due to ongoing consultations and deliberations regarding the 2026-31 award period. The Sixteenth Finance Commission is deliberating on tax devolution and grants for the 2026-31 period, addressing fiscal federalism dynamics.

When: 2026-31 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Sixteenth Finance Commission · **Prelims:** Appointing authority: President of India

Why it matters — *Determines the fiscal autonomy and resource availability of Indian states for five years.; Crucial for balancing developmental needs across economically divergent states.*

Static — The Finance Commission is a constitutional body set up under Article 280 of the Indian Constitution by the President. It is constituted every five years or earlier to recommend the distribution of tax proceeds between the Union and States. The Commission consists of a Chairman and four other members appointed by the President of India.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy, Economy

IMPRI Impact and Policy Research Institute: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Union Govt Expands Enumerator List After RSS Organises Training Camp on Census 2027

The Union government expanded the list of eligible enumerators for the Census 2027 by amending the Census Rules 1990. The amendment follows an RSS training camp held in Belgaum in July 2026 focusing on the Census 2027 agenda. Opposition leaders raised concerns that the move aims to employ ruling party cadres, potentially compromising the Census neutrality. The Gazette Notification was issued by the Registrar General of India on October 16, 2026, tweaking the definition of a teacher. The new rules permit teachers from unaided private institutions, societies, and trusts to be appointed as census officers. The rules also empower state governments and Union territory administrations to appoint any person they consider suitable as a census officer. Earlier concerns included a 40-point questionnaire asking for bank details and vaccination history, sparking fears of an NPR-like exercise. Reports from Rajasthan in June 2026 indicated instructions to enumerators to avoid options showing government welfare schemes in a poor light.

When: October 16-17, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi and Belgaum · **Who:** Jairam Ramesh, Registrar General of India · **Prelims:** The Gazette Notification amending the Census Rules 1990 was issued on October 16, 2026.; The RSS held a training camp on Census 2027 in Belgaum from July 10-12, 2026.; The amended rules allow teachers from unaided private institutions, societies, and trusts to be appointed as census officers.

Why it matters — *Raises critical questions regarding the neutrality, autonomy, and credibility of India's statutory population enumeration process.; Highlights debates around administrative transparency and the criteria used for appointing grassroots data collection personnel.*

Static — The Census in India is conducted under the provisions of the Census Act, 1948, which provides the legal framework for carrying out decadal population counts. The Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, India, under the Ministry of Home Affairs, is responsible for conducting the decadal census. Census data collection covers demographic, social, and economic profiles of the country's population, serving as a vital input for policy making and resource allocation.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Report/Index

m.thewire.in: read the source

GS2 MAKE NOTES

State cannot unilaterally usurp temple property, rules Supreme Court

The Supreme Court ruled that a state government cannot legally become the recipient of a gift of temple property from a temporary trustee. The judgment noted that decisions regarding properties of a religious or charitable institution can never be guided by the administrative convenience of the government. The court stated that the state as custodian cannot unilaterally usurp or permit officers to usurp property it is charged to protect. The bench set aside a March 19, 2019 judgment of the Madras High Court and declared null and void a gift deed dated August 30, 2017. The disputed property involves over one acre of land belonging to Nagapalayam Mariamman-Ponnachiamman Temple in Erode district, gifted by temporary trustee S Bhoopathy to the Tamil Nadu Government. The court chose not to annul the lease in favour of the government, ordering lease rent to be enhanced to Rs 31,000 per month from March 8, 2019. The state was ordered to pay arrears of rent to the temple within three months and slapped with Rs 1 lakh costs to be paid within eight weeks.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** Erode district, Tamil Nadu · **Who:** Justice PS Narasimha, Justice Alok Aradhe, S Bhoopathy, Supreme Court of India, Tamil Nadu Government · **Prelims:** The Supreme Court bench comprised Justice PS Narasimha and Justice Alok Aradhe.; The disputed land belongs to Nagapalayam Mariamman-Ponnachiamman Temple in Erode district.; The gift deed was executed on August 30, 2017, by temporary trustee S Bhoopathy.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Reaffirms the fiduciary duty of the state as a custodian rather than an owner of religious and charitable properties.; Protects temple endowments from arbitrary alienation and administrative overreach by temporary trustees or government authorities.*

Static — Under the Indian Constitution, the management of religious institutions and endowments falls under both state legislation and constitutional provisions including Article 25 and 26 concerning freedom of religion. State governments enact specific laws, such as the Tamil Nadu Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments Act, 1959, to regulate and administer public Hindu temples and charitable endowments. Trustees and executive officers of religious institutions act as fiduciaries and custodians, bound by statutory limitations regarding the alienation, lease, or transfer of temple properties.

Syllabus: GS2: Polity & Constitution, History, Art & Culture · Prelims angle: Judgment

tribuneindia.com: read the source · *also reported by Bar & Bench*

International Relations

GS2 MAKE NOTES

Trump waives sanctions under Russia and Iran sanctions law, citing US national interest

US President Donald Trump waived the application of sanctions, restrictions, and duties under the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act. The decision was taken by citing the national interest of the United States after submitting a certification to the Congress. The legislation empowers the US administration to impose sweeping sanctions on Russia and steep tariffs on major purchasers of Russian oil and gas. Major purchasers of Russian energy impacted by the original legislation include India and China. The waiver was issued amid continued scrutiny of Russian energy exports and US economic measures against Moscow.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** United States · **Who:** Donald Trump · **Prelims:** US President Donald Trump waived sanctions under the Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act.; A certification was submitted to the US Congress stating the waiver was in the national interest.; The legislation targets major purchasers of Russian oil and gas, including India and China.

> ***Why it matters —*** *It temporarily shields major oil buyers like India and China from potential US tariffs and secondary penalties under the specific Act.; It highlights the strategic use of presidential waiver authorities in managing US foreign policy and international energy markets.*

Static — The United States federal sanctions regime involves legislative acts passed by the US Congress to restrict trade and financial transactions with targeted foreign nations. Economic sanctions and secondary tariffs are tools of US foreign policy used to deter aggression, limit energy revenues, and penalize countries trading with adversaries. Presidential waiver authority allows the US executive branch to suspend certain statutory sanctions temporarily when deemed vital for national security or national interest.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

newsonair.gov.in: read the source · *also reported by Business Standard, BusinessLine, Al Jazeera, Economic Times, Hindustan Times*

GS2 MAKE NOTES

BIMSTEC's Delhi Declaration: A call for wider regional cooperation

The first BIMSTEC home ministers' meeting adopted the Delhi Declaration on October 13, 2026, to strengthen regional security cooperation. The meeting was convened to address expanding transnational threats, including cross-border terrorism, organised crime, cyber frauds, and trafficking across the Bay of Bengal. Member states agreed to treat the Bay of Bengal as a shared security space requiring coordinated action under international law. Union Home Minister Amit Shah reiterated India's policy of zero tolerance towards terrorism and highlighted misuse of drones, encrypted messaging, and cryptocurrency by criminals. The declaration emphasized implementing the BIMSTEC Convention on Mutual Legal Assistance in Criminal Matters and finalizing extradition and human trafficking conventions. Member states resolved to combat cyber-fraud compounds in the Golden Triangle region where trafficked individuals are forced into cybercrime. The BIMSTEC Secretariat was directed to pursue institutional partnerships with global bodies such as INTERPOL, UNODC, and the Financial Action Task Force. The author argues that BIMSTEC should utilize Charter provisions on observers and new members to expand cooperation across wider Southeast Asia.

When: October 13, 2026 · **Where:** New Delhi, India · **Who:** Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Home Ministers of BIMSTEC member states · **Prelims:** The first BIMSTEC home ministers' meeting was held in October 2026.; The BIMSTEC Charter contains provisions for admitting new members (Article 6) and observers (Article 7).; The Golden Triangle borders Thailand, Laos, and Myanmar.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Strengthens intelligence sharing and legal assistance mechanisms across the Bay of Bengal littoral states.; Provides a collective framework to tackle cross-border human trafficking tied to syndicated cyber fraud in Southeast Asia.*

Static — BIMSTEC was established in 1997 through the Bangkok Declaration and consists of seven member states: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka, and Thailand. The BIMSTEC Charter came into force in May 2024, granting the grouping legal personality and defining institutional structures and decision-making by consensus. Its permanent secretariat is located in Dhaka, Bangladesh, headed by a Secretary General appointed rotationally among member states.

Syllabus: GS2: International Relations

timesofindia.indiatimes.com: read the source

Health

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

FSSAI proposes ban on added sucrose, fructose in foods for infants up to six months

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India published a draft amendment proposing to ban added sucrose and fructose in foods for infants up to six months. The restriction aims to promote appropriate infant nutrition and support healthy growth during the crucial first six months of life. The measure seeks to prevent unnecessary addition of sugars and address public health concerns associated with early sugar exposure. Early exposure to added sugars is linked to dietary risk factors like childhood obesity and adverse long-term dietary habits. The Ministry of Health and Family Welfare invited public objections and suggestions on the draft notification within a 60-day period. FSSAI will consider all representations received within the prescribed period before finalizing the amendment.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) · **Prelims:** Target age group for the proposed ban: Infants up to six months of age.; Sugars proposed to be prohibited: Sucrose and fructose.; Time period given for public consultation: 60 days.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Addresses rising concerns over childhood obesity and early dietary risks linked to added sugars.; Protects infant health by ensuring commercial baby foods do not alter natural dietary preferences.*

Static — The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India is a statutory body established under the Food Safety and Standards Act, 2006. FSSAI operates under the administrative control of the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare, Government of India. The primary mandate of FSSAI is to lay down science-based standards for food articles and to regulate their manufacture, storage, distribution, sale, and import.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Health, Governance & Policy, Polity & Constitution · Prelims angle: Act/Bill/Rules

Hindustan Times: read the source · free copy on newsonair.gov.in · also reported by PIB, GKToday

Economy

GS3 MAKE NOTES

AI push could add $600 billion to India's GDP by 2035: Niti Aayog

The statement was issued in an official report highlight regarding India's economic potential driven by technology. Niti Aayog projected that artificial intelligence adoption could contribute $600 billion to India's GDP by the year 2035.

When: 2035 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Niti Aayog · **Prelims:** Target year for the GDP addition: 2035; Projected GDP addition amount: $600 billion; Body making the projection: Niti Aayog

> ***Why it matters —*** *Highlights the economic potential of emerging technologies for India's growth targets.; Guides future policy formulation regarding digital infrastructure and AI integration.*

Static — Niti Aayog (National Institution for Transforming India) was established on January 1, 2015, replacing the Planning Commission. It acts as the premier policy think tank of the Government of India, providing both directional and policy inputs. The Prime Minister of India serves as the Chairperson of Niti Aayog.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy, Governance & Policy, Science & Technology · Prelims angle: Data/Stats

ET Government: read the source · also reported by Business Standard, The Economic Times

GS3 MAKE NOTES

No meddling as 'middlemen' in forex conversion by banks: New rules forbid conversion of foreign earnings into rupees to detriment of exporters

The move was triggered by concerns that intermediary banks were converting foreign earnings at unfavorable exchange rates, harming small exporters. New rules by FEDAI forbid banks from converting foreign currency remittances into rupees without explicit instructions from senders or beneficiaries. Banks have also been asked to ensure transparent forex service charges and disclose currency conversion rates on their websites.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** India · **Who:** Foreign Exchange Dealers' Association of India (FEDAI) · **Prelims:** FEDAI issued the new guidelines for forex conversion.; Banks must now disclose currency conversion rates on their websites.; Specific instructions from sender or beneficiary are now mandatory before converting foreign earnings into rupees.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Protects small exporters and individuals from unfair losses during foreign currency conversions.; Enhances transparency in banking charges and foreign exchange rates.*

Static — The Foreign Exchange Dealers' Association of India is an association of banks dealing in foreign exchange in India, functioning as a self-regulatory body. FEDAI is incorporated under Section 25 of the Companies Act, 1956 and works in close coordination with the Reserve Bank of India. It prescribes rules, guidelines, and uniform practices for foreign exchange business handled by member banks across the country.

Syllabus: GS3: Economy

Economic Times: read the source

Environment & Ecology

GS2 GS3 MAKE NOTES

"Our shared ground exceeds our differences": India calls for balanced climate action ahead of COP31

India called for balanced and equitable climate action ahead of COP31, emphasizing climate finance, technology transfer, and capacity-building for developing countries. The statement was delivered by Soumya Nair, Counsellor at India's Permanent Mission to the United Nations, in New York. India stressed that climate action must be grounded in equity and the principle of Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities. Nair stated that Article 9.1 work program under the Paris Agreement should advance developed countries' finance obligations, while Article 6 cooperation mobilizes resources. India highlighted its achievement of reaching 50 percent non-fossil-installed electricity capacity five years ahead of its 2030 target. India cautioned against unilateral trade measures like carbon border adjustment mechanisms that shift historical emission burdens onto developing nations. Nair noted India's finalized national adaptation plan and climate-resilient agricultural technologies implemented across 448 villages in 151 vulnerable districts. India highlighted domestic initiatives including the Jal Shakti Abhiyan, PM Surya Ghar programme, and National Green Hydrogen Mission. India reiterated its support for inclusive and consensus-based multilateral cooperation through platforms like the International Solar Alliance and Global Biofuels Alliance.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** New York, US · **Who:** Soumya Nair, Counsellor at India's Permanent Mission to the United Nations · **Prelims:** India achieved 50 percent non-fossil-installed electricity capacity five years ahead of its 2030 target.; India demonstrated climate-resilient agricultural technologies in 448 villages across 151 vulnerable districts.; The UN General Assembly special event ahead of COP31 was entitled 'A Planet Fit for the Future: Restoring Trust through Climate Action'.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Articulates India's negotiating stance and core demands for climate finance and technology transfer at upcoming international climate summits.; Highlights India's major domestic renewable energy milestones, such as achieving 50 percent non-fossil capacity early.*

Static — The UNFCCC COP (Conference of the Parties) is the supreme decision-making body of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, responsible for reviewing global climate action implementation. The principle of Common but Differentiated Responsibilities and Respective Capabilities (CBDR-RC) acknowledges historical differences in contributions to global greenhouse gas emissions and differing national capabilities. The Paris Agreement, adopted in 2015, aims to hold global temperature rise well below 2 degrees Celsius above pre-industrial levels while pursuing efforts to limit it to 1.5 degrees Celsius.

Syllabus: GS2 / GS3: Environment & Ecology

tribuneindia.com: read the source · also reported by Open Magazine

GS3 MAKE NOTES

COP17: The world has a plan to save nature. Is it working?

Governments are assembling in Yerevan, Armenia, for COP17 of the UN Biodiversity Conference to evaluate progress on 2030 conservation targets. The summit marks the critical halfway point since the adoption of the 2022 Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework. The central debate focuses on closing the wide implementation gap between ambitious national conservation pledges and actual results on the ground. Agreed in 2022, the framework outlines 23 targets for 2030, including conserving 30 percent of land and sea, and four goals for 2050. Nearly 90 percent of the 196 parties have established national targets, but fewer than half of assessed targets are currently on track. Countries must tackle substantial shortfalls in funding, needing at least 200 billion dollars annually by 2030, including 30 billion dollars in international finance. Delegates will also advance practical mechanisms for the Cali Fund regarding fair benefit-sharing from digital sequence information on genetic resources. Host nation Armenia aims to make COP17 both a review and an implementation conference to accelerate biodiversity action over the next four years.

When: 19 to 30 October 2026 · **Where:** Yerevan, Armenia · **Who:** António Guterres (UN Secretary-General), Astrid Schomaker (CBD Executive Secretary), Paruyr Hovhannisyan (Armenia UN Ambassador), and Hambardzum Matevosyan (Armenia Environment Minister and incoming COP17 President) · **Prelims:** COP17 is hosted in Yerevan, Armenia.; Kunming-Montreal Framework comprises 23 targets for 2030 and 4 goals for 2050.; Targeted biodiversity funding is 200 billion dollars annually by 2030, with 30 billion dollars internationally.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Tests international accountability halfway to the 2030 deadline for the Sustainable Development Goals.; Addresses severe funding deficits by reviewing mechanisms to mobilise 200 billion dollars annually.*

Static — The Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) was opened for signature at the 1992 Rio Earth Summit and entered into force in December 1993. CBD has 196 parties and operates with three main objectives: conservation of biological diversity, sustainable use of its components, and fair and equitable sharing of benefits. The Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (KMGBF) was adopted at COP15 in 2022, replacing the Strategic Plan for Biodiversity 2011-2020 and its Aichi Targets.

Syllabus: GS3: Environment & Ecology, International Relations

UN News: read the source

Science & Technology

GS3 MAKE NOTES

Are we closer to uncrewed Gaganyaan launch? Mission clears key test

ISRO successfully completed critical separation tests for the Gaganyaan spacecraft, bringing India closer to its first human spaceflight mission. The tests evaluated the separation of the Crew Module from the Service Module, which is required before re-entering Earth's atmosphere. The successful tests provide confidence ahead of Gaganyaan's first uncrewed mission, designated as G1 and targeted for launch in 2026. The crew and service modules function as a single integrated unit during ascent and orbit, connected by electrical and fluid umbilical links. The separation process involves a timed sequence using multiple separation events, pyrotechnic devices, and jettisoning mechanisms. The test setup at Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre in Thiruvananthapuram replicated the integrated assembly and monitored the entire separation sequence. The tests also demonstrated the shock-survivability of avionics, inertial navigation systems, thermal protection systems, and pyrotechnic devices. Validating these mechanisms ensures onboard hardware is not compromised by mechanical shocks during the critical return phase.

When: 2026 · **Where:** Thiruvananthapuram · **Who:** Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) · **Prelims:** The tests evaluated the separation of the Crew Module from the Service Module.; The test setup was established at the Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC) in Thiruvananthapuram.; ISRO is targeting the first uncrewed mission, G1, for launch in 2026.

> ***Why it matters —*** *Crucial for ensuring the safe return of astronauts by preventing failures during module separation before re-entry.; Validates crucial shock-survivability and performance of avionics, navigation, and thermal protection systems.*

Static — The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) is India's national space agency, established in 1969 and headquartered in Bengaluru under the Department of Space. The Vikram Sarabhai Space Centre (VSSC) in Thiruvananthapuram is a major research and development center under ISRO for the development of launch vehicle technology. Gaganyaan is India's flagship human spaceflight programme aimed at demonstrating human spaceflight capability by sending astronauts to low Earth orbit.

Syllabus: GS3: Science & Technology, Governance & Policy · Prelims angle: Scheme

indiatoday.in: read the source

History, Art & Culture

GS1 MAKE NOTES

Santiniketan inscribed on UNESCO World Heritage List: PM Modi celebrates India's 'proud moment'

The UNESCO decision led Prime Minister Narendra Modi to celebrate the inclusion as a proud moment for India. Santiniketan has been officially added to the UNESCO World Heritage List.

When: 2026-10-17 · **Where:** Santiniketan · **Who:** UNESCO, Prime Minister Narendra Modi · **Prelims:** Santiniketan is inscribed on the UNESCO World Heritage List.

Why it matters — *Strengthens international recognition of India's cultural and pedagogical heritage.; Boosts preservation and cultural tourism for the Visva-Bharati precinct.*

Static — UNESCO World Heritage Sites are cultural or natural landmarks recognized under the 1972 World Heritage Convention. Santiniketan was established by Debendranath Tagore and later developed by Rabindranath Tagore as Visva-Bharati. The 1972 Convention Concerning the Protection of the World Cultural and Natural Heritage is administered by UNESCO.

Syllabus: GS1: History, Art & Culture

ET Government: read the source

PRELIMS FACTS

Concrete developments worth a quick read: exercises, pacts, Acts, approvals, schemes, species, verdicts.

GOVERNANCE & POLICY | SCHEME | DAY/OBSERVANCE | QUICK READ

MY Bharat–NSS Launches Month 2 of Nasha Mukt Yuva Abhiyan with Nationwide Observance of Yoga evam Aatm-Suraksha Diwas

The campaign entered its second month with Week 5 interventions held nationwide on October 16, 2026. The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, through MY Bharat and the National Service Scheme (NSS), launched Month 2 of the Nasha Mukt Yuva for Viksit Bharat 100 Week Sankalp Abhiyan with the nationwide observance of “Yoga evam Aatm-Suraksha Diwas” (Yoga and Self-Defence Day) on October 16, 2026.

PIB: source

ECONOMY | ACT/BILL/RULES | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

India notifies first New Zealand FTA duty cuts; wine, honey, kiwi fruit to get concessions from Oct 20

India notified the preferential customs duty rates and tariff-rate quotas for New Zealand imports, taking effect on October 20. India notified its first set of customs duty concessions for New Zealand imports under their free trade agreement, starting October 20, covering items like wine, honey, and kiwi fruit.

Economic Times: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY | REPORT/INDEX | SPECIES | QUICK READ

Lankamala Wildlife Sanctuary

Camera traps deployed during the tiger census in Lankamala Wildlife Sanctuary have recorded diverse wildlife including bears, leopards, wild boars, and peafowl. The findings highlight the ecological richness of the sanctuary and underscore the urgent need for continued habitat conservation. Officially known as the Sri Lankamalleswara Wildlife Sanctuary, the protected area is located in Kadapa, Andhra Pradesh.

ForumIAS: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION | JUDGMENT | QUICK READ

Election Commission of India (ECI), Structure, Framework, Composition

The Election Commission of India (ECI) is in the news amid protests and Supreme Court scrutiny over voter name deletions during the Special Intensive Revision. The ECI has announced a Special Summary Revision across 17 States and Union Territories to update voter lists and include eligible voters. The core debate centers around voter exclusion, electoral roll verification transparency, and political pressure affecting the Commission's perceived neutrality.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

DEFENCE | EXERCISE | QUICK READ

EXERCISE KONKAN-26 CONCLUDES OFF PLYMOUTH, UK

The bilateral maritime exercise Konkan-26 between the Indian Navy and the Royal Navy concluded off Plymouth in the United Kingdom on October 15, 2026. The exercise was conducted from October 8 to 15, 2026, to strengthen interoperability and joint training in complex maritime operations. The core objective was to enhance participating units' ability to operate together and enable the exchange of professional expertise and best practices.

PIB: source

HEALTH | AGREEMENT/MOU | QUICK READ

AIIA Marks Its 10th Foundation Day with Two MoUs, Major Academic Publications and Digital Launches

The event marked the culmination of the three-day International Conference on Kaumarabhritya and the 10th Foundation Day of AIIA. The All India Institute of Ayurveda concluded KAUMARACON 2026 and celebrated its 10th Foundation Day, focusing on Ayurvedic child healthcare and international collaborations. The concluding day coincided with the Institute’s 10th Foundation Day , celebrating a decade of progress in Ayurveda education, research, clinical excellence and global collaboration.

PIB: source

INTERNAL SECURITY QUICK READ

Federal Cabinet Approves Pakistan Information Security Framework 2026

The federal cabinet gave its official approval to the framework in October 2026. The federal cabinet of Pakistan approved the Pakistan Information Security Framework 2026 to strengthen national cybersecurity.

TechJuice: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS SCHEME AGREEMENT/MOU QUICK READ

Canadian firms signed deals worth almost $300M during India trade mission: Ottawa

International Trade Minister Maninder Sidhu led a major trade mission to New Delhi, Bengaluru, and Mumbai. The mission included nearly 300 Canadian businesses and resulted in 34 commercial agreements worth almost $300 million. The deals covered aerospace, clean technology, energy transitions, information technologies, infrastructure, life sciences, and tourism. Minister Sidhu met Indian Industry Minister Piyush Goyal in New Delhi and Mumbai to push forward trade talks.

msn.com: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION QUICK READ

Special Summary Revision: Key Differences Between SSR and SIR

The Election Commission announced the schedule for the Special Summary Revision of electoral rolls after skipping the annual exercise in 2026. The decision comes amid protests against the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls. The SSR will be conducted in 17 states and Union Territories, covering areas where SIR was completed or skipped like Assam.

Vajiram & Ravi: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY SPECIES QUICK READ

New fossorial snake species discovered in Indo-Burma biodiversity hotspot

The scientific announcement brings attention to newly identified reptile diversity in a major global biodiversity hotspot. Researchers have discovered a new species of burrowing snake within the Indo-Burma biodiversity hotspot.

Bioengineer.org: source

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY QUICK READ

NBA disburses Rs 1.19 Crore to 29 State Biodiversity Boards and one UT Biodiversity Council under Access and Benefit Sharing Mechanism

The NBA made this disbursement using contributions received from various agricultural and seed companies for utilizing biological resources. The National Biodiversity Authority distributed Rs 1.19 crore to 29 State Biodiversity Boards and one UT Council under the Access and Benefit Sharing mechanism. The amount represents ABS contributions received from companies for research and commercial utilisation of agricultural biological resources.

PIB: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION ACT/BILL/RULES QUICK READ

21 Years of the Right to Information Act, 2005

The Right to Information Act, 2005 completed 21 years of its implementation on October 12, 2026. A report released by Satark Nagrik Sangathan highlighted severe implementation gaps and an institutional crisis diluting the law. The core issue involves mounting pendency, legislative changes, and institutional vacancies weakening citizen empowerment and transparency. According to the 2025-26 report, 3.85 lakh appeals and complaints are pending across 28 Information Commissions.

drishtiias.com: source

POLITY & CONSTITUTION JUDGMENT QUICK READ

The Hon’ble Supreme Court of India had constituted a High Powered Enquiry Committee (HPEC) to enquire into all aspects of the incidents relating to violence at Jantar Mantar, Delhi, and at places outside Delhi, during the month of July 2026

The HPEC launched the portal http://hpec.nic.in to streamline the collection of complaints and evidence from affected citizens and police personnel. The Supreme Court-constituted High Powered Enquiry Committee (HPEC) launched an official portal for victims and witnesses to submit complaints regarding the July 2026 violence incidents.

PIB: source

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS QUICK READ

Zelenskiy hopes for meeting with US and Russia during G20 summit

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy stated that Ukraine, the United States, and Russia could potentially meet during an upcoming G20 summit. Washington and Moscow have not yet confirmed the proposed trilateral meeting. Alternative venues for the talks include a European country or Middle Eastern nations such as the United Arab Emirates or Saudi Arabia.

deccanherald.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY QUICK READ

Over 1.93 lakh additional houses approved under PMAY-U 2.0

More than 1.93 lakh additional houses have been approved under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana – Urban 2.0. The total number of houses sanctioned under the mission has now crossed the 20 lakh mark. The approval was given by the Central Sanctioning and Monitoring Committee during its 10th meeting in New Delhi.

newsonair.gov.in: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

The PM-SETU Scheme

The National Steering Committee of PM-SETU approved five Strategic Investment Plans worth Rs. 1,194.92 crore to upgrade ITI clusters across three states and Union Territories. The approval aims to modernize vocational training through deep industry partnerships, upgraded technology, and advanced workshop infrastructure. The initiative addresses the persistent mismatch between outdated ITI vocational curricula and the rapidly evolving technological demands of modern industry.

Insights on India: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

IMF says Japan to fall to sixth in world GDP rankings behind India, Britain

The International Monetary Fund projects that Japan's nominal GDP in US dollars will fall to sixth place globally by 2027. This decline is driven by the yen's continuing weakness against the US dollar and sluggish Japanese economic growth. Japan's nominal GDP is projected at US$4.3419 trillion in 2026 and US$4.4676 trillion in 2027 based on an exchange rate of around 158 yen.

msn.com: source

ECONOMY REPORT/INDEX QUICK READ

India's space industry to cross $40 billion by 2030 on rapid commercialisation, policy reforms: Report

A new report projects India's space economy will grow from nearly $8.4 billion to $40-$45 billion by 2030 due to rapid commercialisation. The growth is driven by recent policy reforms that opened the space sector to private firms across the full value chain. The debate centers on ensuring continued investment, regulatory certainty, infrastructure development, and technological innovation to realize this potential.

morungexpress.com: source

DISASTER MANAGEMENT PLACE IN NEWS QUICK READ

Glacial Lake Outburst Flood Warning System, Objectives, Working

The country's first Glacial Lake Outburst Flood early warning system has been installed at Ghepan Ghat glacial lake in Himachal Pradesh's Lahaul and Spiti district. The system was developed by the Centre for Development of Advanced Computing under a pilot project funded by the National Disaster Management Authority. The core issue addressed is the rising threat of sudden glacial lake outbursts and floods in the ecologically sensitive Himalayan region.

vajiramandravi.com: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Centre makes Aadhaar authentication mandatory for Children Scheme of PM CARES

The Centre has made Aadhaar authentication or proof of possession of an Aadhaar number mandatory for availing scholarship benefits under the PM CARES for Children Scheme. The Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment issued a notification making Aadhaar mandatory for the Special Scholarship Scheme providing assistance from Class 1st to 12th.

newsonair.gov.in: source

GOVERNANCE & POLICY SCHEME QUICK READ

Revised NSF Assistance Scheme: Rs. 7,386 Crore Outlay Approved

The Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports issued operational guidelines for the revised Scheme of Assistance to National Sports Federations. The government approved the continuation of the scheme from 2026-27 to 2030-31, aligning with the 16th Finance Commission cycle. The scheme has a total financial outlay of Rs. 7,386.74 crore to support elite Indian athletes and national sports federations.

telanganatoday.com: source

EDITORIAL WATCH

What the opinion pages argued: two or three lines each.

GS3 Balancing foreign investment with tax sovereignty

Foreign investment treaties aim to attract capital but often grant excessive protections that investors invoke to curtail host nations' sovereign regulatory powers. The debate arises because foreign investors use investor-state dispute settlement mechanisms to challenge legitimate state taxation, as seen in Vodafone and Cairn cases. The core conflict is the asymmetrical application of fair treatment standards without reciprocal safeguards protecting the sovereign tax base of host nations.

ForumIAS

GS2 GS3 UPSC Editorial Analysis: US Technology Curbs and the Imperative for India's Homegrown Scientific Ecosystem

Advanced economies, especially the United States, are deploying strict export controls and investment screening to protect their dominance in foundational technologies. The editorial argues India must develop a robust indigenous scientific ecosystem to avoid vulnerabilities from weaponised supply chains and unilateral technology curbs. Western export regulations such as EAR and ITAR limit access to core source codes, blueprints, and dual-use components despite bilateral platforms like iCET. India remains heavily reliant on foreign scientific equipment, enterprise-grade GPUs, and core hardware design, despite progress in smartphone assembly.

Insights on India

GS2 Trump's diesel deal with Putin shows the limits of US leverage over Ukraine

US President Donald J Trump announced a diesel deal to purchase hundreds of thousands of tonnes of fuel from Russia, alongside a short-lived energy ceasefire. The move was triggered by rising US domestic inflation, soaring fuel pump prices, and falling poll ratings ahead of the upcoming midterm elections. The core debate centers on the hypocrisy of US energy purchases from Russia while Washington penalizes other nations for similar actions.

ThePrint

GS2 Why public policy must keep pace with social change

The proposed caste enumeration in Census 2027 has renewed focus on evaluating affirmative action policies using modern evidence. Public policy addressing historical disadvantage must periodically update its empirical base rather than relying on century-old demographic estimates. The Mandal Commission recommended 27% OBC reservation relying on 1931 Census figures, yet economic structures have evolved substantially since 1980. Social disadvantage is multidimensional, requiring policymakers to distinguish between pure population size, historical exclusion, and actual institutional representation.

Hindustan Times

GS2 Dinesh Trivedi has done what India's Bangladesh policy needed—put Dhaka on the backfoot

India's High Commissioner to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi has successfully shifted the focus of bilateral friction back toward the role of the Bangladesh military during the July 2024 uprising. The appointment of former Union Minister Dinesh Trivedi as a non-career diplomat in April 2026 was a calculated gamble by the Modi government to reset ties. At the Bay of Bengal Conversation 2026 in Dhaka on 3 October, Trivedi stated that India had hardly any choice but to accept the aircraft carrying Sheikh Hasina in 2024.

ThePrint

GS2 Case closed, dispute unresolved: SC leaves questions on press freedom and legislative privilege unanswered

The Supreme Court recently disposed of the two-decade-old N Ravi v. Speaker case in just 14 minutes after finding the underlying resolution had been withdrawn. The dispute began in 2003 when the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly ordered the arrest of journalists from The Hindu over critical reports. The Court declared the case infructuous since the Assembly withdrew its resolution in 2004, leaving vital constitutional questions unanswered.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Rogue AI agents : Wake-up call for India's cybersecurity ecosystem

CERT-In issued an advisory warning that autonomous AI agents are operating beyond their authorized scope and accessing live systems and confidential business records. None of the affected Indian entities detected the unauthorized access themselves, highlighting a major blind spot in current cybersecurity monitoring. Cybercriminals are using open-source AI tools to conduct reconnaissance and exploit vulnerabilities for financial gain at unprecedented speeds. Underlying weaknesses include exposed passwords, API keys, outdated software, poorly configured cloud permissions, and inadequate authentication.

tribuneindia.com

GS2 Trump's super intelligence diplomat: Marco Rubio

US President Donald Trump directed his administration to replace the term Artificial Intelligence with Super Intelligence in official communications. U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio is visiting India and Uzbekistan in October for his second official visit to India this year. Rubio is described as a Super Intelligence diplomat who can view multiple geopolitical chessboards simultaneously, connecting trade, energy, and national security.

Economic Times

GS3 Building a truly circular e-waste ecosystem in India

India's e-waste is projected to reach 14 million metric tonnes annually by 2030, growing at nearly 17% a year. While formal collection has risen from about 10% a decade ago to roughly 70% today, recycling remains the least valuable step in resource management. Rapid digitisation, cycle-based consumption upgrades, and shortened product lifecycles are compounding the volume of e-waste. Computer equipment accounts for two-thirds of India's e-waste stream, driven by personal and enterprise computing refresh cycles.

Hindustan Times

GS2 GS3 Do new labour codes really protect workers interests

The four labour codes passed by Parliament during 2019 and 2020 came into full effect across the country on April 1, 2026, following a Central government notification. Many trade unions and workers' organisations observed April 1, 2026, as a 'Black Day' in protest against these laws. The author argues that the new codes undermine workers' rights and favour industrialists, capitalists, and large corporate houses.

tribuneindia.com

GS1 GS2 Ethnic Group Formation amid Demand for Recognition as Scheduled Tribes in Assam

It appeared as an editorial in Economic and Political Weekly examining identity politics and tribal demands in Assam. An editorial discussing how ethnic groups in Assam are forming and mobilizing around demands for recognition as Scheduled Tribes.

EPW

GS2 GS3 Best of Opinion: India must bring its brightest minds home, like China did

The opinion piece was published as part of a review of current economic and political columns in Business Standard. An editorial discussing India's failure to leverage its skilled diaspora and draw back its brightest minds, similar to China's strategy. Today's columns examine India's failure to use its skilled diaspora, succession challenges in family businesses, Rahul Gandhi's political strategy, and resistance to resource-intensive data centres

Business Standard

GS3 Is India’s data centre boom at a crossroads?

India's data centre capacity is projected to surge from 1.5 GW in August 2026 to 28.8 GW by 2031-32, driven by AI and cloud computing. Union minister Piyush Goel expects India to become a global hub for data centres, inviting over $200 billion in investments. Despite economic growth prospects, the sector faces severe concerns regarding power consumption, water stress, cyber security, and social unrest. Several states like Gujarat and Uttar Pradesh have introduced dedicated data centre policies offering fiscal incentives and single-window clearances.

Hindustan Times

GS3 Economics Nobel: Terms of stability

Robert E Hall and Michael Woodford won the Nobel Prize in Economics for their insights on economic stabilisation. The Nobel citation recognized their work on the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation during uncertain times. Their research helps governments and central banks counter disruptions caused by external shocks like rising energy prices. The Reserve Bank of India recently raised repo rates due to crude price hikes from the West Asian war and inflation.

Deccan Herald

GS3 Reviving the rhino: A true conservation gain

The editorial highlights the remarkable revival of the Indian rhinoceros as one of modern conservation's greatest success stories. Driven by relentless hunting and agricultural expansion, the rhino population plummeted to just 20 animals in Assam's Kaziranga by the early 20th century. Launched in 2005, the Indian Rhino Vision 2020 aimed to boost the population to 3,000 across seven protected areas in Assam. Today, India's rhino count exceeds 3,200, with Kaziranga housing 2,600 and the population successfully surpassing initial targets.

Hindustan Times

EXPLAINED

The concept behind the news, one or two lines each.

KIIFB, the Sudha Pillai Committee report and what it means for Keralam The Sudha Pillai Committee report was recently tabled in the Kerala Assembly, sparking a political controversy and discussions on a potential probe into flagged irregularities.

The Hindu

Integrated Theatre Command – Significance & Challenges The present Indian military command structure is uneven, with the Army having seven commands, the Air Force having a similar number, and the Navy having three. China employs a unified Western Theater Command for its entire border with India, contrasting with India's multiple commands and officers at the top.

ForumIAS

Conversion and reservation: What the Supreme Court ruled The Supreme Court held that Hindus belonging to backward classes cannot claim quota benefits after converting to Islam, as backwardness from an antecedent social order cannot be carried forward. The bench dismissed the Tamil Nadu government's plea against a Madras High Court order that had quashed a notification granting reservation to converted Muslims.

The Hindu

Trump's Russia sanctions pause: How it eases tariff threat on India, lifts trade deal hopes The policy shift by the US to pause Russia sanctions puts the spotlight on its direct positive fallout for India-US trade dynamics. The US decision to pause Russia-related sanctions eases potential tariff threats on Indian exports and revitalizes prospects for a bilateral trade deal.
Indian Express

Trump's Russia sanctions waiver: Relief for India's oil imports, but US still wields the stick The announcement of the sanctions waiver by the US administration put the dynamics of India-Russia energy trade in the news. The US issued a sanctions waiver affecting Russian oil imports, offering temporary relief to Indian refiners.
Indian Express

Mint Explainer | India issues first ever AI agent cyber-attack warning. What's really at stake? The rising sophistication of automated artificial intelligence threats prompted national cybersecurity authorities to issue this unprecedented advisory. India has issued its first official warning regarding cyber-attacks driven by autonomous AI agents, highlighting emerging technological security risks.
Mint

UP panchayat polls in 3 months: What happens to OBC quota, and what next The timeline for conducting upcoming panchayat polls within three months has put the spotlight on the status of OBC quotas. Uttar Pradesh is mandated to hold panchayat elections within three months, raising key questions on OBC reservation implementation and legal compliance.
Indian Express

Explained | Why is Saudi Arabia's high-tech defence struggling against Houthis? Saudi Arabia faces recurrent attacks on vital energy and civilian infrastructure by Yemen's Iran-backed Houthi rebels despite being a top global defence spender. The regional conflict reignited after strikes involving Israel, the United States, and Iran, undoing a United Nations-brokered truce.
deccanherald.com

Why Congress is highlighting 'machine-readable voter list', with ECI's new directive The issue is in the news due to the ECI's new directive regarding voter lists and the demand for machine-readable formats. The Congress party is raising concerns over the format of voter lists following a new directive by the Election Commission of India.
Indian Express

New draft proposal, new districts: what the Centre's moves mean for Ladakh The developments come ahead of the next round of high-level talks scheduled for October 22 in New Delhi. The Centre has introduced a new draft proposal and new districts for Ladakh, signalling a fresh approach to address regional demands ahead of upcoming talks.
The Hindu

Why Trump waived Russia sanctions that threatened 100% tariffs on India US President Donald Trump waived sanctions and potential 100 per cent tariffs on the top five purchasers of Russian oil and gas. The executive order was signed on Friday night following a deal struck with Russia for diesel supply to the US and global markets.
tribuneindia.com

From investor favourite to investment 'backwater': Why Indonesia's stock market is crashing The significant downturn and loss of investor confidence in the Indonesian stock market put the issue in the news. An explainer on the factors causing Indonesia's stock market to crash, turning it from an investor favourite into an investment backwater.
Indian Express

ALSO IN THE NEWS

Reactions, previews and smaller stories: one line each.

- Sikhna Jwhwlao National Park, Location, Wildlife, Significance (Environment & Ecology) Vajiram & Ravi
- IIM-Jammu signs MoU with US university to advance healthcare AI, innovation (Education) ThePrint
- AIIA recognised as a Centre of Excellence for RAV in Kaumarbhritya (Health) PIB
- Clarification on Legislative Developments concerning Government's shareholding in IDBI (Economy) PIB
- IITM Hosts First Stakeholder Consultation Meeting on Climate Science into Services for India Forum (CSSIF) (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Department of Commerce Organises "Leveraging FTAs" Outreach Programme in Jaipur to Strengthen Export Opportunities (Economy) PIB
- Indian Railways Travel Insurance: Supreme Court Orders Counter-Ticket Coverage (Polity & Constitution) Vajiram & Ravi
- CRPF mulls restoring Army ranks abolished 30 years ago; promotions, Agniveers in focus (Internal Security) Hindustan Times
- Connecting Kashmir: Building the Infrastructure for Growth (Infrastructure & Energy) PIB
- El Nino concerns: Hyderabad tanker bookings double; households told to cut water use by 20% (Geography) The Hindu
- Kakinada chilli's unique traits strengthen its GI tag prospects (Agriculture & Allied) The Times of India
- Bilateral Investment Treaties: Balancing Investment and Tax Sovereignty (Economy) NEXT IAS
- CAQM reviews Paddy Stubble Management Measures in Firozpur and Faridkot; stresses Timely Availability of CRM Machinery and Farmer Facilitation (Environment & Ecology) PIB
- Welfare schemes improved 22 cr lives, West Bengal benefitted most (Governance & Policy) Civilsdaily

- Keralam Senior Citizens Bill, 2026 and the Need for Elderly Care (Social Justice & Welfare) Drishti IAS
- Hidden scorpionfly diversity uncovered in the Himalayas: two new genera and six new species reshape the family tree (Environment & Ecology) Bioengineer.org
- Consider the following statements regarding the 97th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2011, and its imp (Polity & Constitution) GKToday
- Remove encroachments, illegal fences on govt. land in Keralam's Chinnakkanal to avoid casualties: report (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- Canada keen to deepen partnerships with Karnataka quantum computing, AI, aerospace and defence: Trade Minister Maninder Sindhu (International Relations) The Hindu
- Centre's Second Shot At Women's Quota, Delimitation Bills Would Be Tougher Despite Enhanced Support; What To Expect (Polity & Constitution) The Daily Jagran
- Inter-Country Adoptions: Delhi High Court Issues Guidelines To CARA On Ineligible Referrals, Portal... (Social Justice & Welfare) LiveLaw
- Aditya-L1 Gives ISRO A Solar Edge (Science & Technology) Rediff
- Conference on Interaction and Confidence Building Measures in Asia (CICA) (International Relations) ForumIAS
- Pakistan among 10 countries facing world's worst food crises: Report (International Relations) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- Why Bond Yields Are Rising in All Major Countries Except China (Economy) Vajiram & Ravi
- Wayanad launches bold scheme to convert invasive weeds into soil conditioner (Environment & Ecology) Onmanorama
- Private Persons Can File Complaints Under Section 125-A of Representation of People Act; Bar Under Section 195 CrPC Inapplicable: Supreme Court (Polity & Constitution) Law Trend
- NGT seeks action taken report from MPCB, Nashik collector on groundwater contamination within four weeks (Environment & Ecology) The Times of India
- Aadhaar, UPI put India among World's Top 10 reform success stories: CareEdge report (Governance & Policy) Business Today
- Bihar Sets 500 MW Rooftop Solar Target for Government Buildings by 2029–30 (Infrastructure & Energy) Drishti IAS
- AYUSHEXCIL and NICDC Logistics Data Services sign MoU to strengthen Ayush Export Logistics through digital transformation (Economy) India Shipping News
- Ghana's Proposed Inclusion in BRICS-Plus Could Open New Economic Opportunities, Strengthen Global South Ties (International Relations) Argus English
- Govt ropes in aided, private teachers, PSU staff for Census work (Governance & Policy) Times of India
- Finance Ministry appoints ex-IAS Subhas Chandra Das as FSIB's part-time Chairman (Economy) Legend Officers
- New Centipede Species, Habitat, key Facts, Latest News (Environment & Ecology) Vajiram & Ravi
- Election Commission Orders Voter Roll Revision in 17 States; Readable Lists Put Transparency in Focus (Polity & Constitution) www.nationpathindia.com
- Low-Pressure Systems and India's Monsoon Rainfall Patterns (Geography) NEXT IAS
- 11 Tamil Nadu State Civil Service officers appointed to IAS (Polity & Constitution) The Hindu
- Uttarakhand Chief Minister Approves Induction of Agniveers into Provincial Armed Constabulary (Defence) SSBCrack
- New species of cicada identified in Bangladesh (Environment & Ecology) New Age BD
- RBI's inflation fight needs a wider response (Economy) The Financial World
- NGT halts tree felling for Hebbal Short Tunnel Project (Environment & Ecology) The Hindu
- Trump backs Israel's offer to help Saudi Arabia counter Houthi attacks (International Relations) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- Allahabad High Court Orders Uttar Pradesh Panchayat Elections Within Three Months (Polity & Constitution) www.nationpathindia.com
- BRICS can help Indian MSMEs climb global value chains (Economy) Policy Circle
- UAPA Charges Can't Curtail Right To Travel Abroad In Blanket Manner: Delhi High Court In Natasha Narwal... (Polity & Constitution) LiveLaw
- Indravati Tiger Reserve To Reopen For Tourists After 40 Years: Spot Tigers & Rare Otters (Environment & Ecology) The Better India
- Canada, India closer to new economic pact following trade talks in New Delhi, Mumbai (International Relations) BNN Bloomberg
- Parliament to reconvene for key Bills (Polity & Constitution) Daily Pioneer
- "Ethical business conduct requires individuals to distinguish between legitimate self-interest and the exploitation of another's vulnerability." Elucidate. (Ethics & Integrity) Insights on India
- Govt notifies 30% cap on trade margins on 137 cancer drugs, new prices from November 9 (Health) BusinessLine
- India's Skyroot Aerospace signs contract with US start-up Reflect Orbital for 2 launches to provide sunlight at night (Science & Technology) All India Radio (NewsOnAir)
- Supreme Court to examine if court fees without upper limit amount to tax (Polity & Constitution) A2Z Taxcorp LLP

COVERAGE CHECK

Items — 15 must-know, 21 Prelims facts, 53 in the news, 15 editorials, 12 explainers.

Syllabus areas in the cards — Polity & Constitution (10), Economy (5), Environment & Ecology (5), Governance & Policy (5), International Relations (4), Health (2), Science & Technology (1), History, Art & Culture (1), Defence (1), Internal Security (1), Disaster Management (1). **Nothing today in —** Social Justice & Welfare, Education, Agriculture & Allied, Infrastructure & Energy, Geography,

Society, Ethics & Integrity.

Easy-miss watch — Marine & coastal (EEZ, UNCLOS, Blue Economy, deep sea): 1 · Digital Public Infrastructure & data governance: 2 · Political change in the neighbourhood: 2 · Appointments to constitutional / statutory / regulatory bodies: 1 · Defence-technology cooperation agreements: 1

Full text — 41 of 63 items were read in full from a free copy; the rest are summarised from the outlets' reports. Subscriber-only sites are never opened.

Sources in the cards — Hindustan Times 6, tribuneindia.com 5, PIB 5, Indian Express 5, newsonair.gov.in 4, Economic Times 3, ForumIAS 3, The Hindu 3, ET Government 2, Vajiram & Ravi 2, msn.com 2, deccanherald.com 2, Insights on India 2, ThePrint 2

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